Franklin Crypto Research Competition @ UBC

We are excited to announce Year 3 of the annual Franklin Crypto (Franklin Templeton) research competition at the University Blockchain Conference. The competition will run from Oct 22nd to Nov 9th, culminating in a live pitch competition on **November 20th** in Austin, TX. This unique event provides students with the opportunity to engage in high-level investment research, gain access to free Blockworks, and Allium's research tools, and compete for a $10,000 prize.

Timeline

Competition Sign Up Opens / Activation Week - **Oct 22 (Thursday)** onwards
Competition Start / Kick-off Town Hall - **Oct 22 @ 8PM EST**
Blockworks + Allium Demo Call - **Oct 29 @ 8PM EST**
Written Report Submission Deadline - **Nov 9 11:59PM EST**
Written Report Judging - **Nov 9 to Nov 15**
Finalists Announced - **Nov 16**
Conference Presentations - **Nov 20th**
Winners Announced at Closing Ceremony - **Nov 21st**

Tracks

Participants have the option of competing in one of three different tracks.

1. Long Positions under $250M MC (circulating)
2. Long Positions over $250M MC (circulating)
3. Short Position over $1B MC (circulating)

Each team will select one of the three tracks to pitch within. Your team will select one asset and create a comprehensive investment thesis based on the requirements of the track.

Competition Format

There will be two stages of the research competition.

1. **The written report**

Your team will create a written report on the asset of your choice. You have 5 pages to get your investment thesis across in a concise manner. You will be judged on the validity of your thesis, how thorough and thought out it is, and how well you were able to communicate it. Reports must be

submitted by **NOVEMBER 9th** through the college.xyz website or the submission form on the UBC website. Submissions that are overly AI-generated will be disqualified. **The top 3 teams from each track will advance to the next round.**

2. **The in-person pitch**
If you qualify for this round, you will be pitching in-person to a panel of judges at UBC 2026 on November 20th at the University of Texas, Austin. You will need to create a slide deck to help you highlight key points from your written report and present your thesis to the judges. The in-person pitch must be on the same thesis as the one in your written report. Each team will have a hard stop at 5 minutes so you need to be organized and concise. Use 5 minutes for your pitch, the next 5 will be for judge Q&A. Presenting teams will be notified on November 16th to allow time to prepare their final presentation.

Prize Pool

The entire prize pool totals $10,000 USD and is divided as follows:

Long Position < 250M Track Winner - $2,500
Long Position > 250M Track Winner - $2,500
Short Position > 1B Track Winner - $2,500
Top Team Across All Tracks - additional $2,500

Strata Media Distribution:
The winners for each track will be publicized by Strata Media and the overall winner will be invited to join them on a podcast post-competition (date TBD).

Team Formation

Each team participating in the Franklin Templeton Research Competition must consist of 1-4 students. You may compete solo. Each university can have as many teams submit as they'd like.

Each team must submit one report representing their collective work. If selected as finalists, the team is expected to present at the pitch competition at the University Blockchain Conference on November 20th. Only UBC attendees can participate in this competition.

*Must be attending UBC *and* representing a university group/society to compete.

Report Structure:

1. Length: 5 pages max, excluding title page, appendix and references. Graphs and charts are included

in the 5 page max if you choose to have them embedded in the main text. You may move any figures or charts to the appendix if needed.

2. Title Page: Include the title of the report, the track (Short/Long Investment), team members' names, the school that the team is representing and contact information.

3. Executive Summary: 1 page, covering the key findings and investment thesis

4. Project Overview: Description of the chosen project, including value prop or narrative, product design, team, market analysis, traction, token assessment, upcoming catalysts and risks

5. Investment Proposal: Long/short, investment time horizon, price target for exit

6. Conclusion: Final thoughts summarizing the analysis

7. References: List all data sources, reports, and references used.

Blockworks + Allium Resources

Regarding Blockworks and Allium usage, we will host a virtual session on **Oct 29th at 8PM EST** where representatives from each will demo their respective research tools and explain how to claim exclusive access to their products for a limited time.

Judges/Sponsors

Panelists will be representing Franklin Templeton, No Limit Holdings, Collab + Currency, Blockworks, Portal Ventures, and College.xyz.

Good Luck!